that such food contains higher amounts of essential nutrients and minerals, including vitamin C, iron, and zinc.

- Organic food has no chemical additives whereas conventional farming methods expose foods to chemicals in the form of pesticides, fertilisers, and preservatives. These conventional methods greatly improve productivity but they are very harmful to human beings and can cause irreversible damage.
- Organic food lacks artificial hormones and antibiotics. To maximise productivity, some modern farms inject their livestock with hormones and antibiotics which enter the human body when products like meat, milk, and eggs, are consumed. These chemicals, which are proven to cause hormonal imbalances and drug resistant bacteria in human beings.
- Organic food has increased antioxidants which help in preventing cancer and boosts mental health of children.

DO YOU KNOW?

An organic diet decreases the chances for depression and concentration problems in children (and adults) thereby enchancing their mental health. This means the child will perform better in school, will not feel tired and will work harder than others.In addition, eating organic foods can help with attention deficit disorder (ADD), a common condition among children.

8.6 Kitchen/Terrace Gardening

Landscape gardening is an art of laying out grounds in a way which is ornamental imitating natural scenery. Such gardening is difficult nowadays, due to limited space and increased population. Kitchen/ terrace gardening is a new option available. Kitchen/ terrace gardening is growing of greens, fruits and vegetables at the backyard or terrace of the house by using kitchen waste water. Even balconies can be used for this garden. Old buckets, unused bottles, jars can be used for growing plants. Neem oil and Neem seed kernel extract can be used to protect the plants from weeds.

The advantages of Kitchen/ terrace gardening are given below:

- Fresh fruits and vegetables high in nutritive value.
- Fruits and vegetables free from toxic chemicals.
- Help to save expenditure on purchase of vegetables.
- Vegetables harvested from home garden taste better.
- Effective utilization of kitchen waste water and kitchen waste materials.



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